AI Project Kickoff Checklist

10 Questions to Ask Before You Start

1/ ☐ DEFINE THE PURPOSE

What problem am I solving with the model? Is AI the right tool for the task?

2/ ☐ **CLARIFY SUCCESS**

What is a good result for this project? How can I measure it?

3/ ☐ **PICK THE RIGHT TOOL**

Which AI system (general LLM, image model, domain-specific tool) best fits my needs? What are its limitations?

4/ ☐ **SET THE TONE**

Do I need the model to challenge me, help me simplify, or fact-check? Am I framing my prompts clearly?

5/ ☐ **CHECK THE DATA**

Is the information I'm using sensitive or confidential? Do I know where the data might go?

6/ ☐ **FACT-CHECK OUTPUTS**

What verification process will I use? Can I triangulate with other tools?

7/ ☐ **WATCH FOR BIAS**

Does the result reinforce stereotypes or leave out perspectives? Have I challenged it enough?

8/ ☐ THINK ABOUT IMPACT

Who is being affected by this project? Do you need to obtain approval from or inform other stakeholders?

9/ ☐ PLAN THE WORKFLOW

How will I integrate AI's results into my work? What sort of work can it carry out?

10/ ☐ REFLECT & IMPROVE

How will I evaluate the results and capture lessons learned? If the project is done, what has been created?

PRO-TIP: You can also brainstorm with a model using these questions.